

DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD

A Catalyst for Parking, Housing and Prosperity

Planning-Level Project Development Report

140 Ste. Marie Street
Collingwood, Ontario

Project No. PDR-140SM-001
Revision 0.93A
Editorial Clean Manuscript
July 2026

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Document Control

Project Title	Downtown Collingwood: A Catalyst for Parking, Housing and Prosperity
Document	Planning-Level Project Development Report
Project Number	PDR-140SM-001
Project Location	140 Ste. Marie Street, Collingwood, Ontario
Author	Norman Sandberg, C.E.T.
Revision	Rev. 1.0
Status	Final Publication Master
Issue Date	August 2026
Purpose	Final coordinated publication master covering front matter through Chapter 9.

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description	Status
0.1	February-June 2026	Concept development	Working
0.2	June 2026	Parking optimization	Working
0.3	June 2026	Architectural refinement	Working
0.4	July 2026	Financial analysis	Working
0.91A	July 2026	Clean front matter through Chapter 3	Editorial Clean Manuscript
1.0	August 2026	Final scissor-ramp, financial and publication coordination	Final Publication Master

Document Purpose

This report evaluates the planning-level feasibility of redeveloping the municipally owned property at 140 Ste. Marie Street as a mixed-use development incorporating structured municipal parking, workforce and market rental housing, and ground-floor commercial space. It is intended to support informed public discussion and future municipal decision-making.

Disclaimer

This Planning-Level Project Development Report has been prepared for discussion and evaluation purposes only. The concepts, cost estimates, illustrations and analyses are intended to demonstrate the potential feasibility of the proposed redevelopment and should not be relied upon for detailed design, procurement or construction. Further architectural, engineering, planning, legal, financial and environmental investigations will be required before implementation. Nothing contained in this report constitutes a development approval, funding commitment or endorsement by the Town of Collingwood or any approval authority.

Letter of Transmittal

August 2026

Mayor and Members of Council
Town of Collingwood
55 Ste. Marie Street
Collingwood, Ontario

Re: Downtown Collingwood - A Catalyst for Parking, Housing and Prosperity

Mayor and Members of Council,

I am pleased to submit this Planning-Level Project Development Report for the proposed redevelopment of the municipally owned property at 140 Ste. Marie Street.

The report evaluates the feasibility of transforming an underutilized municipal parking lot into a mixed-use development that combines structured public parking, workforce and market rental housing, and ground-floor commercial space while respecting the character of the Downtown Heritage Conservation District.

The planning-level analysis concludes that the concept is technically feasible and that a public-private partnership offers a practical framework for implementation. The proposal has the potential to increase public parking capacity, introduce new rental housing, strengthen the downtown commercial district and generate long-term assessment growth while preserving municipal ownership of a strategic downtown property.

The estimates and analyses are appropriate for planning-level decision-making. They are intended to support consideration of whether the project should proceed to detailed design, Class C cost estimating, market engagement and formal municipal review.

Respectfully submitted,

Norman Sandberg, C.E.T.
Author

Executive Summary

Introduction

Downtown Collingwood is one of Ontario's most successful small-town main streets. Its continued success depends upon maintaining an appropriate balance between heritage conservation, commercial vitality, residential growth and public infrastructure.

Increasing development pressure has highlighted two recurring challenges: limited public parking and a limited supply of workforce rental housing. This report examines whether both can be addressed through the coordinated redevelopment of an existing municipal parking lot.

The Opportunity

The property at 140 Ste. Marie Street occupies a strategic location immediately south of the Eddie Bush Memorial Arena and within easy walking distance of Hurontario Street. The site currently contains 87 surface public parking spaces. Although the lot performs an important municipal function, it represents a relatively low-intensity use of valuable downtown land.

The proposed redevelopment would retain and expand public parking while introducing residential and commercial uses within the same municipal property. The concept transforms an existing municipal asset into a long-term catalyst for downtown revitalization.

Proposed Development

- **Municipal parking:** a split-level structured parking facility using seven alternating parking datums - P1, H1, P2, H2, P3, H3 and the open-air P4 upper deck - connected by a scissor-ramp circulation system, providing 181 public parking spaces and 15 residential-dedicated spaces, for 196 spaces in total.
- **Residential development:** 30 purpose-built rental apartments, including 22 workforce rental units and 8 market rental units.
- **Commercial development:** approximately 7,300 square feet of street-oriented commercial space within five retail bays.
- **Urban design:** a four-storey, seven-bay building with a recessed fourth floor and a heritage-compatible contemporary architectural expression.

Design Philosophy

The building is divided into seven equal façade bays to avoid a monolithic appearance and to reflect the traditional rhythm of downtown commercial buildings. Bay 4 contains the principal residential lobby and Bay 7 contains the vehicular entrance. The fourth residential storey is recessed approximately 10 feet from the primary façade to reduce its apparent height from the street.

Planning-Level Financial Summary

Item	Value
Municipal Investment	~\$18.106 million
Private Investment	~\$14.8 million
Total Project Investment	~\$32.906 million
Delivery Model	Public-Private Partnership

Planning-level (Class D) estimate.

Principal Benefits

- A substantial increase in public parking capacity.
- New purpose-built workforce and market rental housing.
- Additional commercial assessment and year-round downtown activity.
- More efficient use of municipally owned land.
- A heritage-compatible building that reinforces the Ste. Marie Street frontage.
- A practical catalyst for future downtown revitalization.

The project demonstrates how a single municipal asset can simultaneously address parking, housing, economic development and downtown revitalization.

Recommendation

The planning-level business case demonstrates that the concept is technically feasible and capable of advancing through a public-private partnership. The next phase should include detailed design, Class C cost estimating, market engagement, planning and heritage review, confirmation of funding opportunities and development of an implementation strategy.

Project at a Glance

Downtown Collingwood: A Catalyst for Parking, Housing and Prosperity

Project Vision

Transform an underutilized municipal surface parking lot into a vibrant mixed-use development that expands public parking, provides purpose-built rental housing, strengthens the downtown economy and respects the character of the Downtown Heritage Conservation District.

Project Component	Planning-Level Program
Existing public parking	87 spaces
Proposed public parking	181 spaces
Dedicated residential parking	15 spaces
Total proposed parking	196 spaces
Net increase in public parking	94 spaces
Residential units	30 (22 workforce rental; 8 market rental)
Commercial area	Approximately 7,300 sq. ft.
Building form	Four storeys; recessed fourth floor
Parking structure	Seven alternating datums; split-level / scissor-ramp circulation
Delivery model	Public-private partnership

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Chapter 1 - Introduction

1.1 Purpose of the Report

This Planning-Level Project Development Report evaluates the feasibility of redeveloping the municipally owned property at 140 Ste. Marie Street into an integrated mixed-use development combining structured public parking, workforce and market rental housing, and ground-floor commercial space.

The report has been prepared to assist future municipal consideration of whether the project should proceed to the next phase of development. It assesses technical, planning, operational and financial considerations and establishes a planning-level business case for implementation through a public-private partnership.

The report is not a detailed engineering design, architectural submission or tender estimate. It provides a planning framework upon which subsequent design, consultation, approvals and procurement activities may proceed.

1.2 Study Objectives

- Improve the efficiency of a strategically located municipal property.
- Increase the supply of public parking in the downtown.
- Introduce workforce and market rental housing within walking distance of employment and services.
- Strengthen the downtown commercial environment through additional street-oriented retail space.
- Respect the character of the Downtown Heritage Conservation District.
- Evaluate financial feasibility at a planning level.
- Identify an implementation strategy that balances municipal and private-sector investment.

1.3 Project Background

Downtown Collingwood continues to experience sustained investment and increasing year-round activity. Population growth, tourism, commercial expansion and residential intensification have contributed to rising demand for parking while increasing pressure to accommodate additional housing within the built-up area.

The subject property currently functions as a surface municipal parking lot containing 87 public parking spaces. While the lot provides an important public service, its location and size present an opportunity for more intensive use without sacrificing its primary parking function.

Rather than replacing parking with another use, the concept retains and expands municipal parking through a structured facility while introducing complementary residential and commercial uses.

1.4 Planning Context

- Downtown revitalization.
- Efficient use of municipal land assets.
- Intensification within the existing built-up area.
- Increased housing supply.
- Support for local businesses.
- Improved municipal infrastructure.
- Long-term growth of the municipal assessment base.

The project also reflects the general direction of Provincial planning policy that encourages intensification within serviced settlement areas and more efficient use of existing infrastructure.

1.5 Scope of Work

- Site analysis.
- Conceptual architectural planning.
- Parking analysis.
- Residential and commercial programs.
- Financial feasibility assessment.
- Implementation strategy.
- Planning-level business case.

Detailed structural, mechanical, electrical, geotechnical and environmental design is outside the scope of this revision and would be completed during subsequent project phases.

1.6 Methodology

The report was developed through an integrated planning process drawing upon municipal infrastructure planning, conceptual architectural design, urban design, parking operations, development economics, municipal finance and public-private partnership analysis.

Financial estimates represent planning-level investment allowances based on comparable projects, current Ontario construction conditions and professional judgement. They are suitable for strategic decision-making but require refinement through detailed design and market testing.

Chapter 2 - Existing Conditions

2.1 Site Description

The subject property is municipally owned and occupies a prominent location on the west side of Ste. Marie Street, immediately south of the Eddie Bush Memorial Arena.

The site contains 87 public parking spaces arranged as a conventional surface parking lot. Vehicular access is provided from Ste. Marie Street, and the lot serves the downtown commercial district, nearby civic facilities and community events.

The property is generally rectangular, with approximately 239.6 feet of frontage on Ste. Marie Street and a depth of approximately 148.6 feet. A 10-foot setback separates the proposed building frontage from the Eddie Bush property to the north. The building frontage is planned at approximately 239.6 feet, organized into seven equal bays across approximately 229.6 feet.

2.2 Existing and Surrounding Land Uses

- Eddie Bush Memorial Arena to the north.
- A private property and the Salvation Army site to the south.
- Established commercial and mixed-use development within the downtown core.
- Municipal roads, civic facilities and public parking.
- Heritage commercial buildings throughout the Downtown Heritage Conservation District.

The surrounding area demonstrates the mixed commercial, institutional, civic and residential pattern typical of a traditional Ontario downtown.

2.3 Existing Parking Supply

The existing lot contains 87 publicly available parking spaces. Although the lot performs an essential public function, surface parking represents a relatively low-density use of strategically located municipal land.

Expanding parking horizontally within the downtown is increasingly difficult because of limited land availability and high property values. Structured parking provides an opportunity to increase capacity while retaining the site for broader community use.

2.4 Downtown Context

Downtown Collingwood continues to evolve as a regional commercial, tourism and cultural destination. Increasing residential development, year-round tourism and business investment contribute to higher demand for both parking and housing.

The redevelopment of municipally owned property provides an opportunity to address several municipal priorities through coordinated investment rather than through separate, incremental projects.

2.5 Opportunities and Constraints

Opportunities	Constraints
Municipal ownership; central location; existing parking function; long street frontage; proximity to businesses, civic uses and services; potential for shared infrastructure.	Heritage district context; constrained downtown site; need to maintain safe vehicle circulation; structural coordination; protection of adjacent uses; requirement to preserve the public parking function.

140 STE. MARIE STREET | C1.0 EXISTING SITE CONTEXT PLAN

Existing Conditions (Orthophoto) - Preliminary Municipal Opportunity Study



EXISTING MUNICIPAL PARKING LOT

87 public spaces | municipally owned | Ste. Marie Street frontage

Orthophoto reproduced from the locked C1.0 source. Site context and property outline retained.

140 STE. MARIE STREET

EXISTING SITE CONTEXT PLAN - ORTHOPHOTO / EXISTING CONDITIONS

FIGURE C1.0 LOCKED | ED. 1.0

Chapter 3 - Development Concept

3.1 Vision

The proposed redevelopment of 140 Ste. Marie Street is intended to serve as a catalyst for downtown revitalization by integrating municipal infrastructure with private investment in housing and commercial space.

Rather than replacing public parking, the proposal modernizes and expands it while introducing new residential and commercial uses on the same municipally owned property. The concept demonstrates how strategic public investment can leverage private-sector participation to achieve several community objectives at once.

- Preserve and expand public parking.
- Introduce workforce housing within walking distance of employment and services.
- Strengthen the downtown commercial environment.
- Respect the scale and character of the Downtown Heritage Conservation District.

3.2 Site Organization

The site occupies approximately 239.6 feet along Ste. Marie Street and has a depth of approximately 148.6 feet. The proposed building is positioned along the eastern street frontage to reinforce the traditional downtown street wall.

The building frontage is approximately 239.6 feet. Seven equal bays are arranged across approximately 229.6 feet, with a 10-foot setback at the north beside the Eddie Bush Memorial Arena.

Vehicular access is provided through Bay 7 at the south end of the building. The principal residential entrance is located in Bay 4, establishing a central and highly visible lobby.

3.3 Architectural Design

The architectural expression is intended to complement the historic character of downtown Collingwood without attempting to replicate historic buildings.

The east façade is divided into seven equal bays. The bay sequence from north to south is fixed as follows: Bay 1 Retail; Bay 2 Retail; Bay 3 Retail; Bay 4 Residential Lobby; Bay 5 Retail; Bay 6 Retail; Bay 7 Parking Entry.

The façade is to be composed as four compatible architectural expressions rather than one long, uniform elevation or seven unrelated storefronts. The fourth residential storey is recessed approximately 10 feet from the primary façade to reduce its apparent height from Ste. Marie Street.

Materials are anticipated to include high-quality masonry, glazing, architectural metal and durable contemporary detailing compatible with the Downtown Heritage Conservation District.

3.4 Ground Floor

The ground floor is designed to maximize public activity while maintaining efficient access to the structured parking facility.

Approximately 7,300 square feet of commercial space is distributed among five street-oriented retail bays. Bay 4 contains the recessed residential lobby and shared vertical circulation. Bay 7 contains the parking entrance.

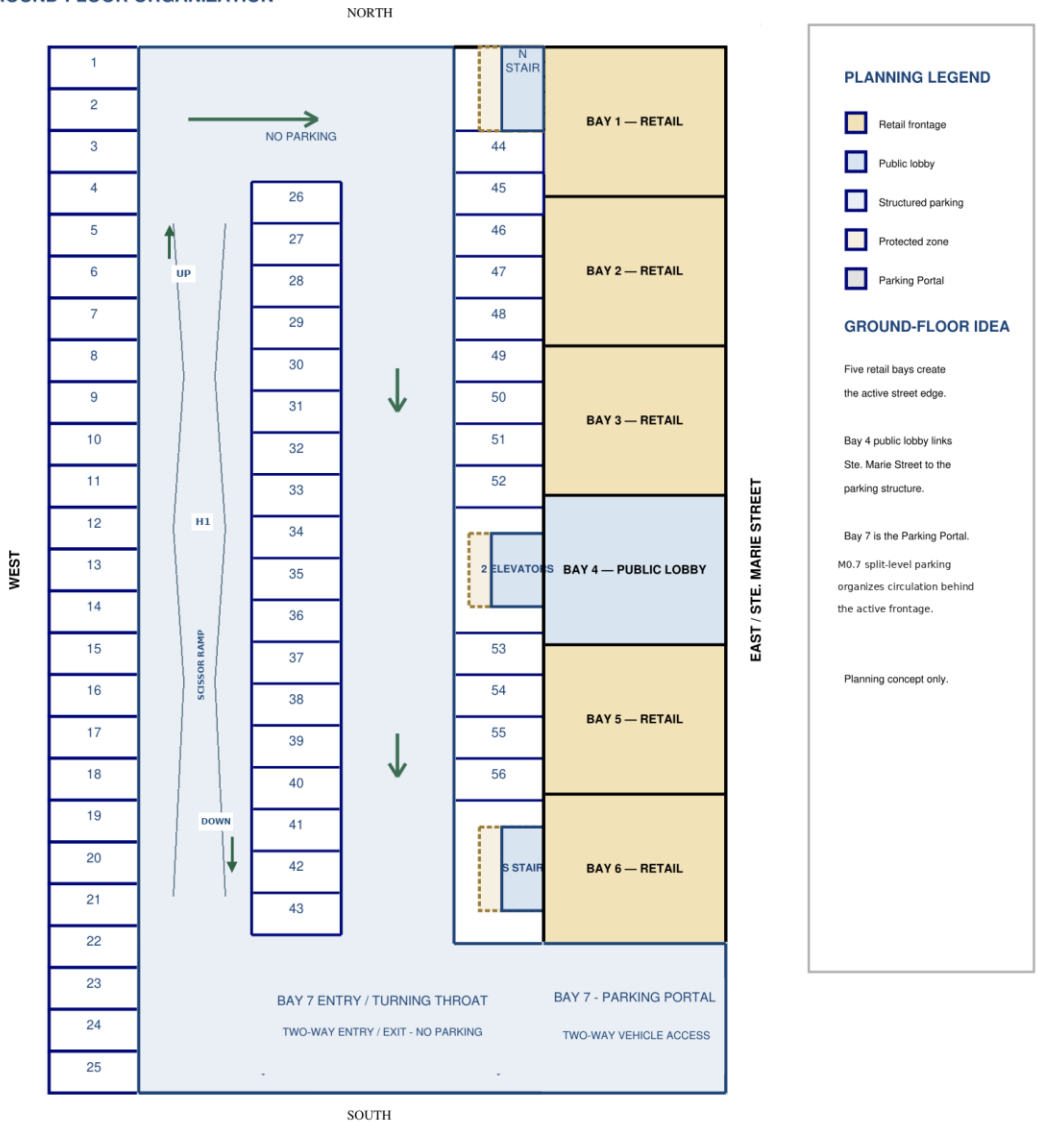
The commercial frontage is approximately 40 feet deep and includes the internal circulation required to separate the storefronts and lobby from the parking structure behind. The parking structure is screened from Ste. Marie Street by the active commercial and lobby frontage.

DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD:
A CATALYST FOR PARKING, HOUSING AND PROSPERITY

FIGURE C2.0
GROUND FLOOR PLANNING CONCEPT

Active Ste. Marie Street frontage with locked M0.7 split-level parking behind

A. GROUND-FLOOR ORGANIZATION



140 STE. MARIE STREET
GROUND FLOOR PLANNING CONCEPT
PLANNING CONCEPT — NOT FOR CONSTRUCTION
SOURCE: M0.7 REV. M LOCKED / M0.6 ARCHITECTURAL CONTROLS

FIGURE
C2.0
SITE / GROUND FLOOR

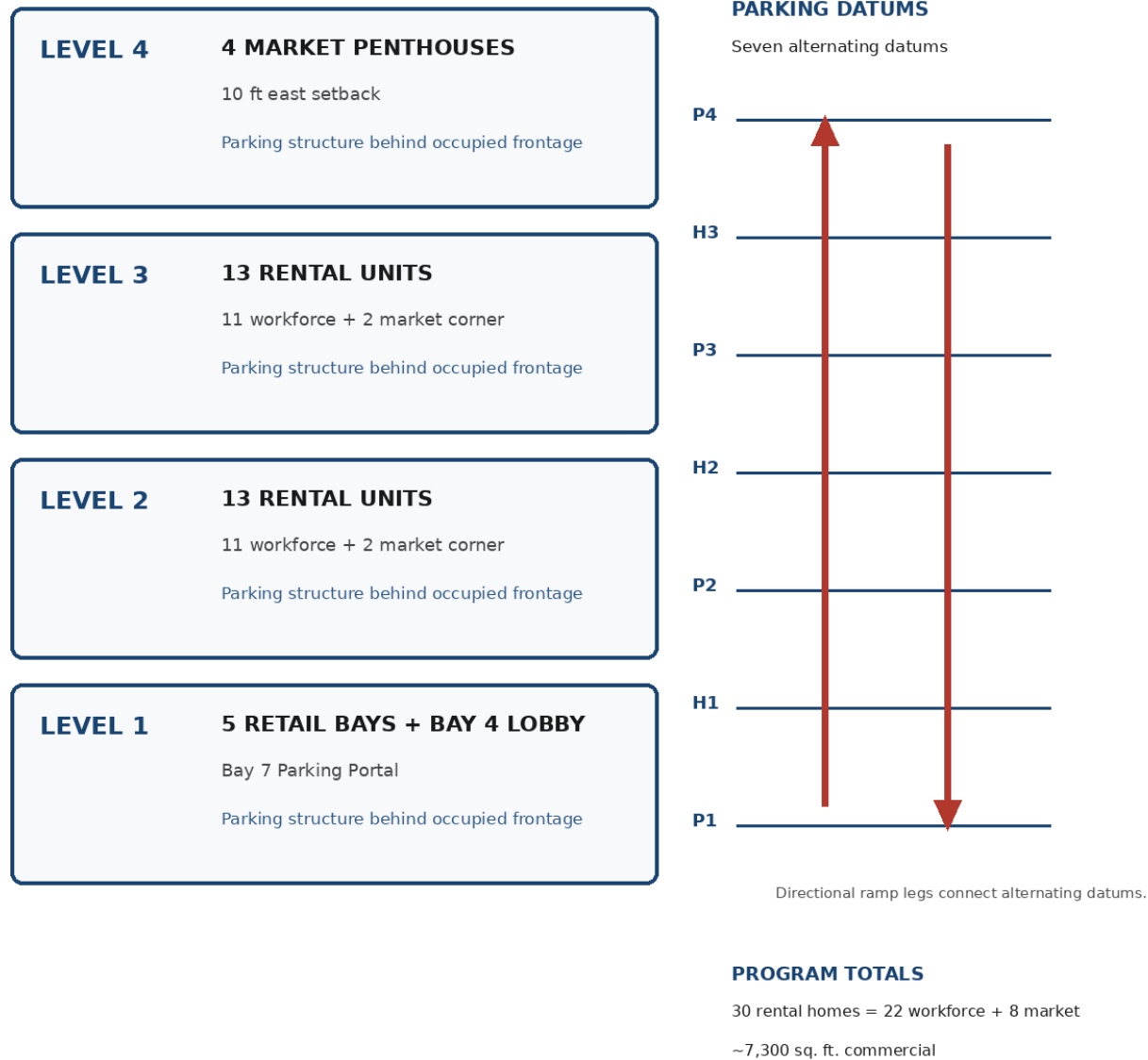
EDITION
4.2CH
FINAL - LOCKED

DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD:
A CATALYST FOR PARKING, HOUSING AND PROSPERITY

FIGURE C3.0

FLOOR ORGANIZATION

Building program and split-level parking relationship - diagrammatic organization only



3.5 Residential Floors

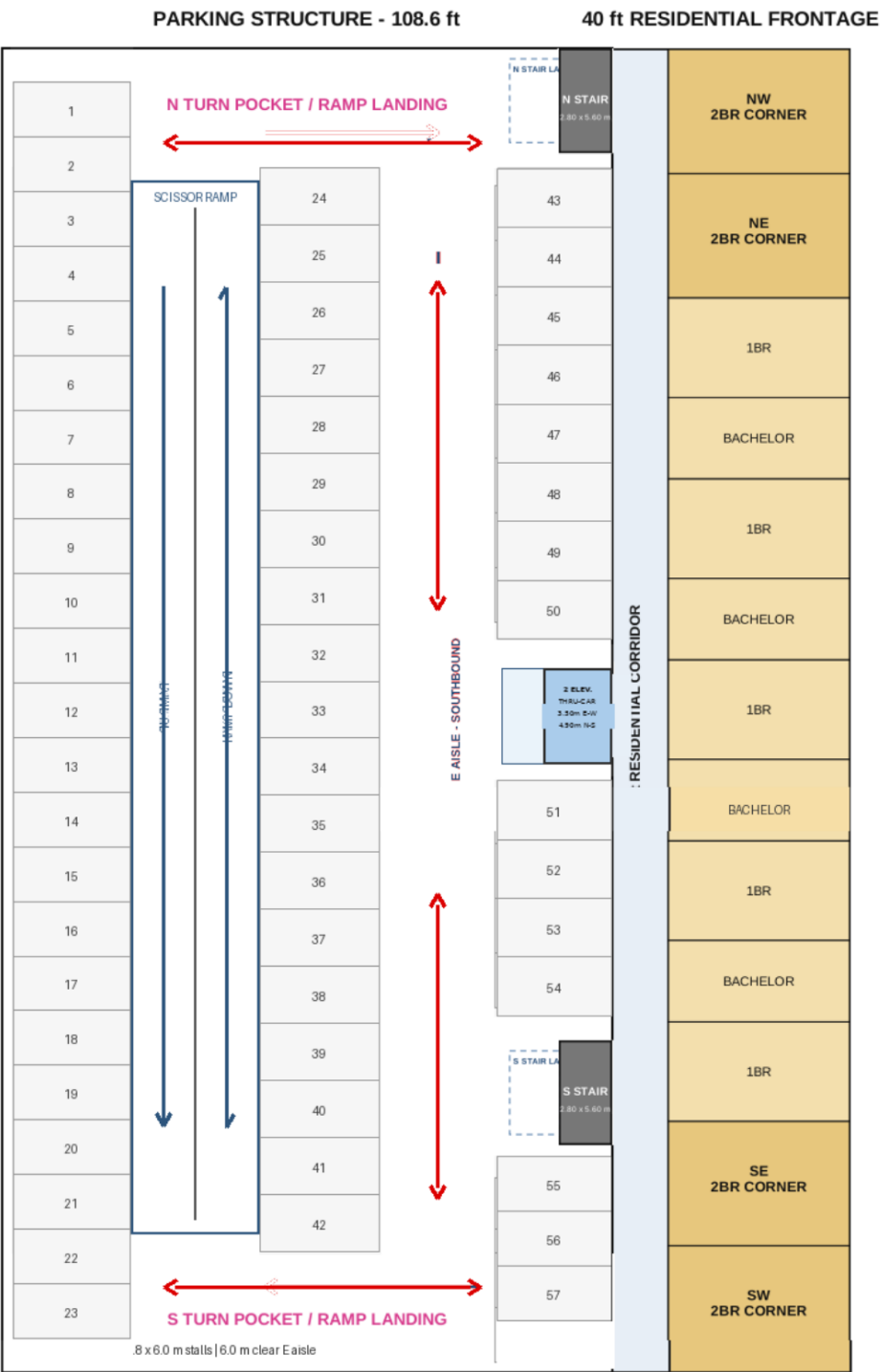
Levels 2 and 3 each accommodate 13 residential units. The recessed fourth level contains 4 larger market units, for a total of 30 apartments.

Unit Category	Number
Workforce rental units	22
Market rental units	8
Total	30

The residential program includes bachelor, one-bedroom and two-bedroom units. The corner two-bedroom units on Levels 2 and 3 and the four fourth-floor units are market units; the remaining 22 units are workforce rental housing.

DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD:
A CATALYST FOR PARKING, HOUSING AND PROSPERITY

FIGURE C4.0 - TYPICAL RESIDENTIAL AND PARKING LEVELS 2 AND 3



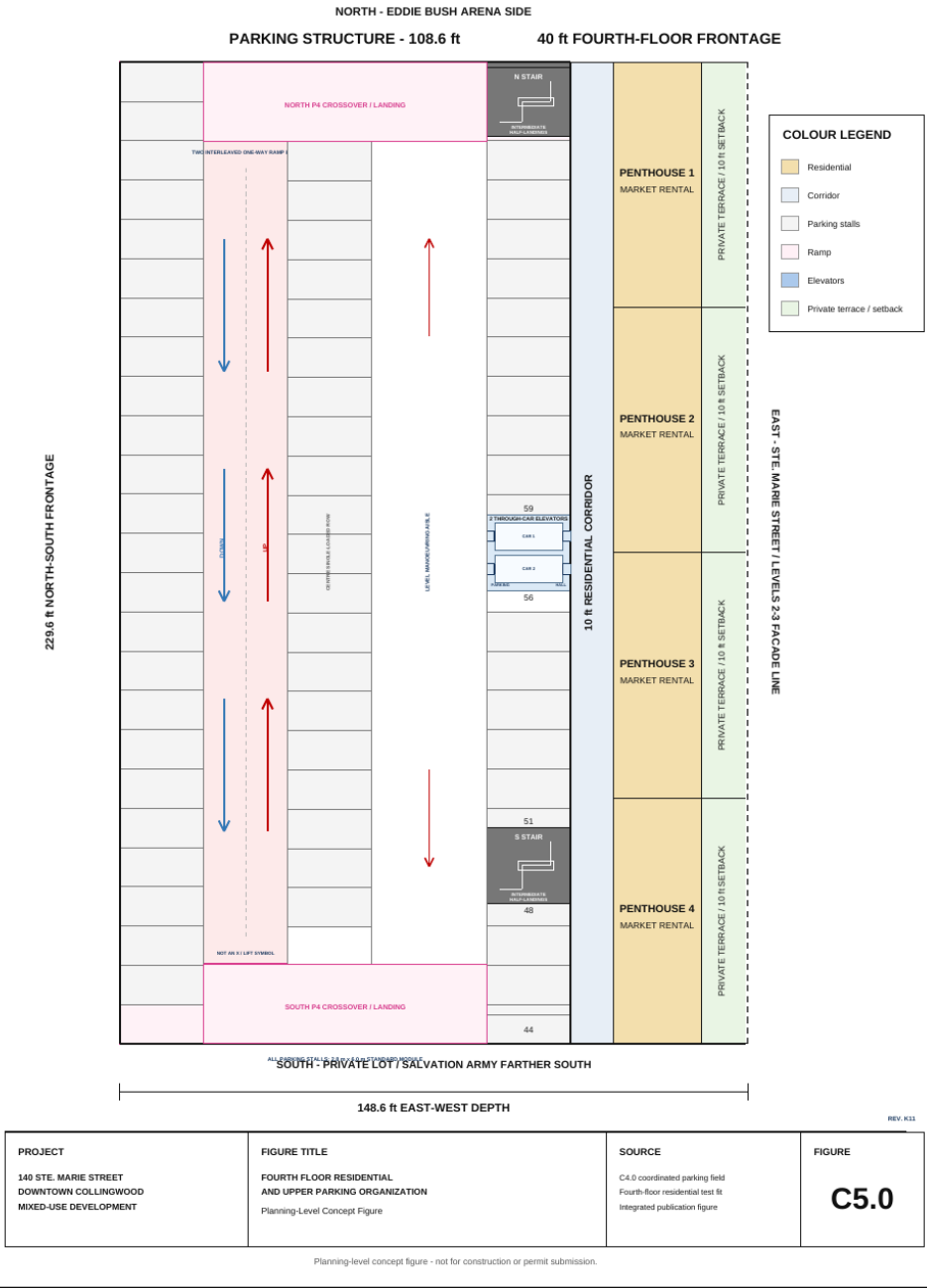
PROJECT 140 STE. MARIE STREET DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD MIXED-USE DEVELOPMENT	FIGURE TITLE TYPICAL RESIDENTIAL AND PARKING LEVELS 2 AND 3 Planning-Level Concept Figure	SOURCE / CONTROL C4.0 Rev. 4.6P locked figure Elevator note removed / field restored 8.5 x 11 portrait	FIGURE C4.0 EDITION 4.7P
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**DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD:
A CATALYST FOR PARKING, HOUSING AND PROSPERITY**

FIGURE C5.0

FOURTH FLOOR RESIDENTIAL AND UPPER PARKING ORGANIZATION

Planning-level publication figure



3.6 Parking Structure

The structured parking facility forms the foundation of the development. The preferred concept uses seven alternating parking datums - P1, H1, P2, H2, P3, H3 and the open-air P4 upper deck - connected by a split-level scissor-ramp circulation system.

The verified planning-level program provides 196 spaces in total: 181 public parking spaces and 15 residential-dedicated spaces. Compared with the existing 87 public spaces, the concept provides a net increase of 94 public parking spaces.

Parking Measure	Spaces
Existing public parking	87
Proposed public parking	181
Dedicated residential parking	15
Total proposed parking	196
Net increase in public parking	94

The parking layout uses a double-loaded centre field, a northbound east aisle, a southbound west aisle and a ramp generally aligned along the west wall. Turn pockets are provided at the ends of the aisles. Final counts and geometry remain subject to detailed architectural, structural and Building Code coordination.

- Typical stall size of approximately 8.5 by 18 feet.
- Drive aisle widths generally within the 20-to-23-foot range.
- A ramp gradient of approximately 15 percent with 7.5 percent transition grades.
- Accessible parking, bicycle parking and EV-ready infrastructure.
- Secure pedestrian connections to the residential lobby and vertical circulation.

3.7 Heritage Compatibility

- Articulated building massing.
- Seven equal-width architectural bays.
- A recessed fourth floor.
- Active ground-floor commercial uses.
- Transparent storefront glazing.
- High-quality masonry and durable materials.
- Pedestrian-scaled entrances.
- A rhythm and proportion compatible with the traditional downtown streetscape.

The proposal is intended to complement the established character of downtown Collingwood while remaining clearly identifiable as contemporary construction.

3.8 Universal Accessibility

- Barrier-free residential entrance and commercial access.
- Accessible elevators serving all levels.
- Accessible parking spaces.
- Continuous accessible pedestrian routes.
- Barrier-free residential units in accordance with applicable Building Code requirements.
- Accessible washroom facilities within commercial units where required.

Universal accessibility will be refined through detailed design and code review. The planning concept establishes a clear basis for an inclusive and welcoming development.

DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD: A CATALYST FOR PARKING, HOUSING AND PROSPERITY

FIGURE C6.0
INTEGRATED MUNICIPAL CATALYST

Planning-level publication figure coordinated with A1.1 Edition 1.7 locked architectural façade.



A1.1 EDITION 1.7 LOCKED EAST FAÇADE — 140 STE. MARIE STREET

1 PUBLIC PARKING

- 196 total structured stalls
- 87 existing surface stalls
- 15 stalls dedicated to residential
- 181 public structured stalls
- +94 net new public stalls

2 WORKFORCE HOUSING

- 22 workforce rental homes
- Levels 2–3
- Close to employment and services
- Supports year-round community

3 MARKET HOUSING

- 8 market residences
- Corner units + penthouses
- Private Level 4 terraces
- Supports project viability

4 COMMERCIAL SPACE

- Approximately 7,300 sq ft
- Five active storefronts
- Street-oriented commercial space
- Supports local business

5 HERITAGE COMPATIBILITY

- Heritage-compatible architecture
- Traditional downtown scale
- Seven equal bays / 3–1–3 composition
- Strengthens Ste. Marie streetscape

6 MUNICIPAL ASSET

- Municipal land ownership retained
- Parking remains municipal
- Private residential/commercial component
- Long-term public land value

INTEGRATED COMMUNITY OUTCOMES	Downtown Revitalization	Public Parking	Workforce Housing	Commercial Activity	Heritage Character	Municipal Land Value

PROJECT 140 STE. MARIE STREET DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD MIXED-USE DEVELOPMENT	FIGURE TITLE INTEGRATED MUNICIPAL CATALYST Parking • Housing • Commercial Activation Planning-Level Concept Figure	SOURCE / CONTROL M0.7 SCISSOR PARKING GEOMETRY · LOCKED A1.1 EAST FAÇADE ED. 1.7 — LOCKED C6.0 INTEGRATED PUBLICATION FIGURE	FIGURE C6.0 EDITION 2.7 · LOCKED
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Planning-level concept figure – not for construction or permit submission. 140 STE. MARIE STREET



Existing streetscape and municipal parking lot viewed from Ste. Marie Street.



Planning Narrative

This municipally owned parking lot represents one of Downtown Collingwood's most significant redevelopment opportunities. Its size, location and public ownership make it well suited to support public parking, workforce housing, local businesses and long-term downtown revitalization.

At a Glance

- 87 existing public parking spaces
- 249.6 ft frontage
- 148.6 ft depth
- Municipal ownership
- Adjacent to Eddie Bush Memorial Arena
- Downtown Collingwood Heritage Conservation District

DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD:
A CATALYST FOR PARKING, HOUSING AND PROSPERITY

FIGURE C8.0
STREETSCAPE INTEGRATION

A heritage-compatible mixed-use frontage
designed to strengthen Ste. Marie Street.

PLANNING INTERPRETATION

DOWNTOWN FIT

The proposed frontage is divided into seven equal bays, avoiding the appearance of one continuous building face. Material changes, recessed entrances and storefront rhythm respond to the scale and character of the Historic Downtown.

ACTIVE STREET EDGE

Five commercial bays, a central residential lobby and a clearly defined parking portal create an active and legible ground floor. The arrangement supports pedestrian activity, downtown businesses and day-to-evening use.

HERITAGE RESPONSE

The four-storey form, recessed upper level, vertical proportions and varied masonry expressions are intended to complement the Heritage Conservation District without imitating a single historic building.



KEY TAKEAWAY

The planning concept presents a complete downtown frontage. Parking access is integrated without allowing it to dominate the street.



PROJECT INTEGRATION

PARKING & ACCESS	HOUSING	COMMERCIAL ACTIVATION	MUNICIPAL OPPORTUNITY
196 structured spaces 181 public + 15 residential +94 net new public spaces Bay 7: two-way parking portal	30 purpose-built rental apartments 22 workforce + 8 market 13 units on each of Levels 2 and 3 4 market penthouses on Level 4	~7,300 sq. ft. commercial space 5 active storefronts Parking remains behind the active Ste. Marie Street frontage	Municipal ownership retained Expanded public parking, housing and commercial activity combined on one downtown property

INTEGRATED OUTCOME | A heritage-compatible frontage that adds public parking, rental housing and active commercial space without allowing parking to dominate Ste. Marie Street.

AT A GLANCE

MUNICIPAL PROPERTY 140 Ste. Marie Street	SITE FRONTAGE 239.6 ft	PROPOSED HEIGHT 4 Storeys (Recessed 4th Floor)	GROUND FLOOR Retail, Lobby, Parking Access	RESIDENTIAL UNITS Levels 2-4

PARKING

196 spaces

SCALE NOTE

The photographically verified neighbours are shown at the same relative scale.
The proposed building height is set so the top of Level 3 matches the top of the arena grille and the base matches the arena base.



NORTH



PROJECT

140 STE. MARIE STREET
DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD
MIXED-USE DEVELOPMENT

FIGURE TITLE

STREETSCAPE
INTEGRATION

Planning-level concept figure

SOURCE / CONTROL

Real Photographs
(Supplied)

C6.0 Integrated Municipal
Catalyst Edition 2.6
(Approved Facade)

A1.1 East Facade
Edition 1.7 – Locked

Publication layout only

FIGURE

C8.0

EDITION

1.0

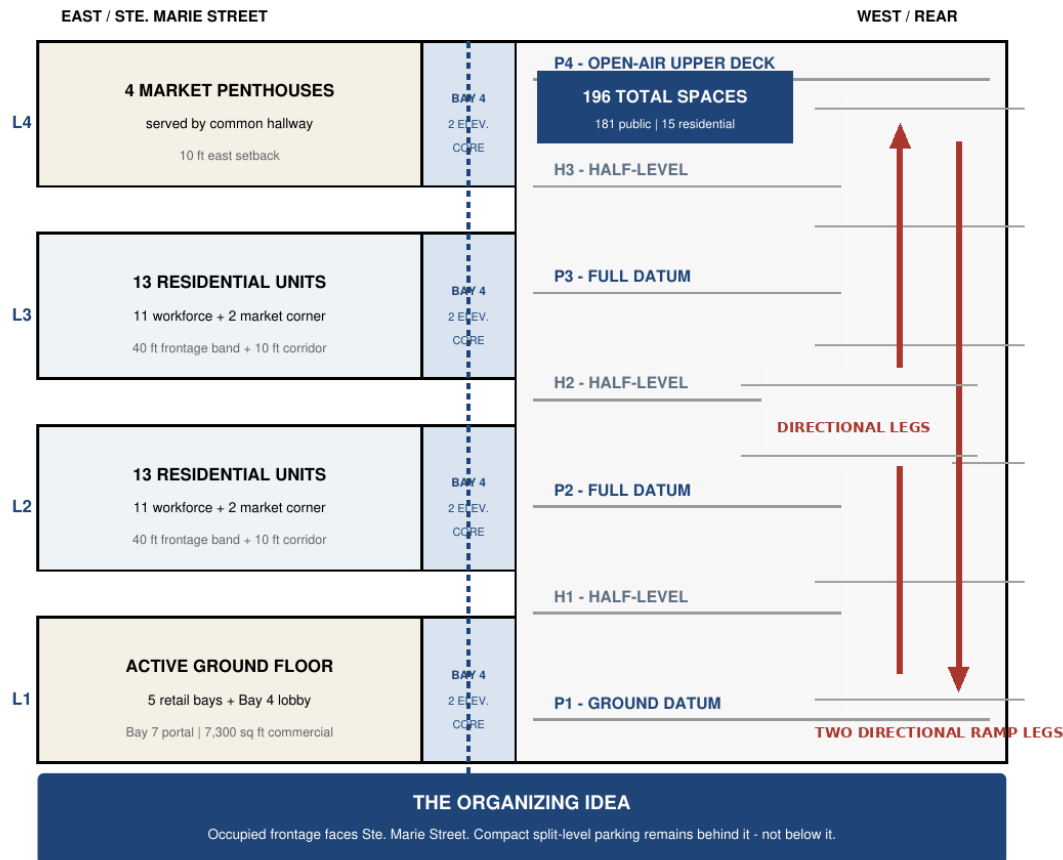
FINAL REPORT

EDITION 1.8

DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD:
A CATALYST FOR PARKING, HOUSING AND PROSPERITY

FIGURE C9.0
BUILDING ORGANIZATION

Planning-level organization diagram - occupied Ste. Marie frontage with split-level structured parking behind



PROGRAM AT A GLANCE

- 30 homes = 13 + 13 + 4: 22 workforce rental + 8 market.
- Levels 2-3: 13 units per floor; Level 4: four market penthouses; frontage recessed 10 ft.
- Parking uses seven : P1, H1, P2, H2, P3, H3 and open-air P4.

SOURCE / CONTROL

Sectional organization diagram updated to locked M0.7 Rev. M parking basis.
Seven parking datums and scissor circulation are diagrammatic; no plan-view geometry is superimposed.
M0.6 architectural frontage/bay geometry remains intact. Planning concept only - not for construction.

Chapter 3 Summary

The development concept demonstrates that the municipal parking lot can be transformed into a high-quality mixed-use project without sacrificing its primary public parking function. By integrating structured parking, workforce and market rental housing, and active commercial frontage within a heritage-compatible four-storey form, the concept establishes a practical model for downtown intensification and municipal land stewardship.

Acknowledgement

The author acknowledges the informal input of experienced professionals and community stakeholders in municipal planning, engineering, architecture, parking design, housing, downtown revitalization and economic development. That input assisted in testing assumptions and strengthening the concept. No endorsement by any individual, organization, agency or approval authority is implied. The conclusions and recommendations remain those of the author.

Chapter 4

Parking Analysis

4.1 Introduction

Public parking has long been recognized as one of the critical pieces of infrastructure supporting Downtown Collingwood. Unlike roads or water systems, parking does not simply serve motorists—it supports local businesses, tourism, employment, cultural activities, civic facilities and downtown living.

The purpose of this chapter is to evaluate the existing parking conditions at 140 Ste. Marie Street and demonstrate how structured parking can significantly increase parking supply while supporting new housing and commercial development on the same municipal property.

The analysis has been undertaken from the perspective of a municipal parking enterprise, recognizing parking as essential public infrastructure rather than as a stand-alone commercial venture.

4.2 Existing Conditions

The subject property currently functions as a surface municipal parking lot containing 87 public parking spaces.

While the existing lot performs an important public function, surface parking represents one of the least efficient uses of strategically located downtown land. The current configuration occupies virtually the entire site while providing only a single level of parking.

Surface parking also exposes vehicles to weather, provides limited opportunities for electric vehicle infrastructure, and offers little flexibility for future intensification.

Table 4-1 – Existing Parking Inventory

Description	Existing
Public Parking Spaces	87
Residential Parking	0
Commercial Parking	Shared Public Supply
Parking Levels	1
Municipal Land Utilization	Low

Figure 4-1 - Existing Surface Parking Layout

Existing municipally owned surface parking lot - 87 public spaces



4.3 Planning Objectives

The parking strategy was developed around five primary objectives:

1. Increase public parking capacity without acquiring additional downtown land.
2. Maintain convenient public access to downtown businesses and civic facilities.
3. Support new residential development with dedicated resident parking.
4. Provide safe and intuitive vehicle and pedestrian circulation.
5. Design a structure capable of adapting to future transportation technologies, including electric vehicle charging and changing travel patterns.

These objectives recognize that parking must remain a public asset while enabling broader community development.

4.4 Parking Design Philosophy

The proposed parking structure is not simply a garage. It forms the structural and operational foundation of the entire mixed-use development.

Several guiding principles shaped the design:

- Municipal parking remains the primary use of the site.
- Residential and commercial uses are layered above and in front of the parking structure.
- Vehicle circulation is simplified through a one-way system.
- Vehicle circulation is organized through a split-level scissor-ramp system serving the alternating parking datums.
- Parking decks are designed with regular structural grids to reduce construction complexity and long-term maintenance costs.

- Natural light and ventilation are incorporated wherever practical.

By integrating parking with other land uses, the project transforms a necessary municipal expense into an investment that also delivers housing, commercial activity and increased municipal assessment.

4.5 Design Development

The parking layout presented in this report is the result of multiple design iterations undertaken to balance operational efficiency, structural feasibility and architectural requirements.

Throughout the design process, several principles remained constant:

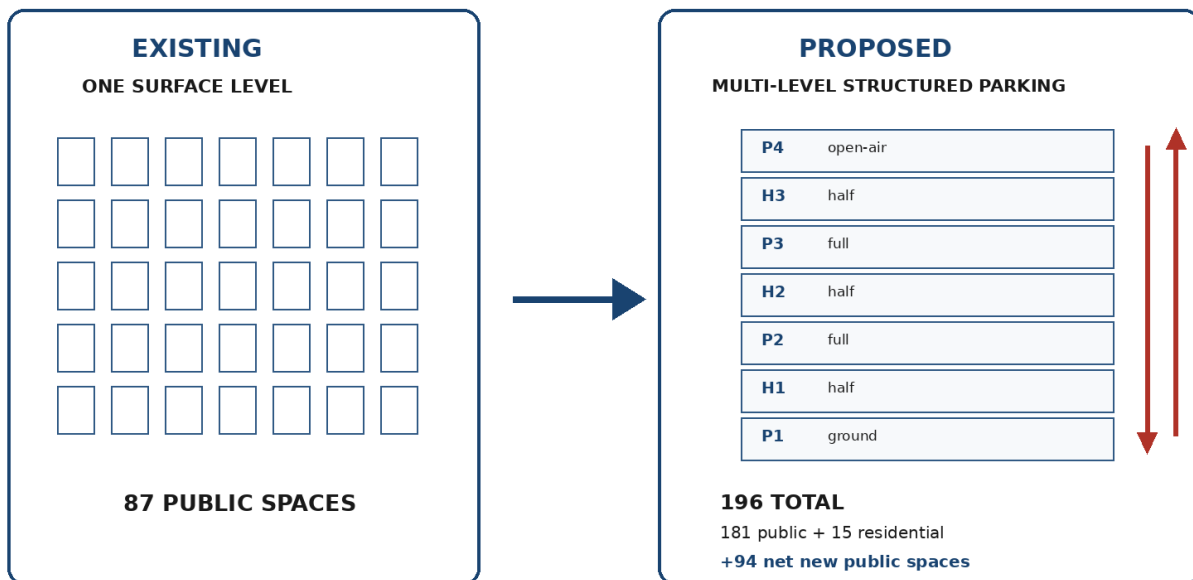
- The seven-bay architectural façade was preserved.
- The Bay 4 residential lobby remained centrally located.
- The Bay 7 parking entrance remained at the south end of the building.
- Residential parking requirements were accommodated within the structure.
- The split-level scissor-ramp circulation concept was retained to maximize usable parking capacity within the controlled site envelope.

Successive iterations refined stall geometry, aisle widths, turning movements and ramp alignment to optimize capacity while maintaining safe vehicle operation.

Figure 4-2 – Parking Design Evolution - Existing surface lot to proposed ground-floor/structured-parking concept

Figure 4-2 - Parking Design Evolution

Single-level surface parking to multi-level split-level structured parking



4.6 Proposed Parking Supply

The proposed development replaces a single-level surface parking lot with a multi-level split-level structured parking facility using seven alternating parking datums integrated into the mixed-use building.

The structure provides:

- Public parking serving the downtown core;
- Dedicated parking for residential tenants;
- Accessible parking spaces;
- Bicycle parking;
- Electric vehicle charging capability; and
- Modern lighting, security and wayfinding.

Fifteen parking spaces are allocated to the residential component in accordance with the Town of Collingwood Zoning By-law requirement of 0.5 parking spaces per dwelling unit for the proposed 30-unit development. These stalls remain revenue-generating assets but are reserved for residential tenant use.

The remaining spaces continue to serve the municipal public parking system, substantially increasing parking availability for downtown businesses, visitors and community facilities.

Table 4-2 – Proposed Parking Program

Description	Proposed
Existing Public Parking Supply	87 spaces
Dedicated Residential Parking	15 spaces
Estimated Net Increase in Public Parking	94 spaces
Parking Levels	Seven alternating parking datums

**The estimated net increase is based on the current planning-level design and parking optimization completed for this report. Final parking counts will be confirmed during detailed architectural, structural and Building Code design.*

Author's Observation

Structured parking is often evaluated solely on the basis of parking revenue. In established downtowns, however, its broader value lies in supporting commercial activity, enabling housing, increasing municipal assessment and making more efficient use of strategically located municipal land.

Accordingly, the parking component of the 140 Ste. Marie Street Catalyst Project should be evaluated as essential municipal infrastructure rather than as an independent profit centre.

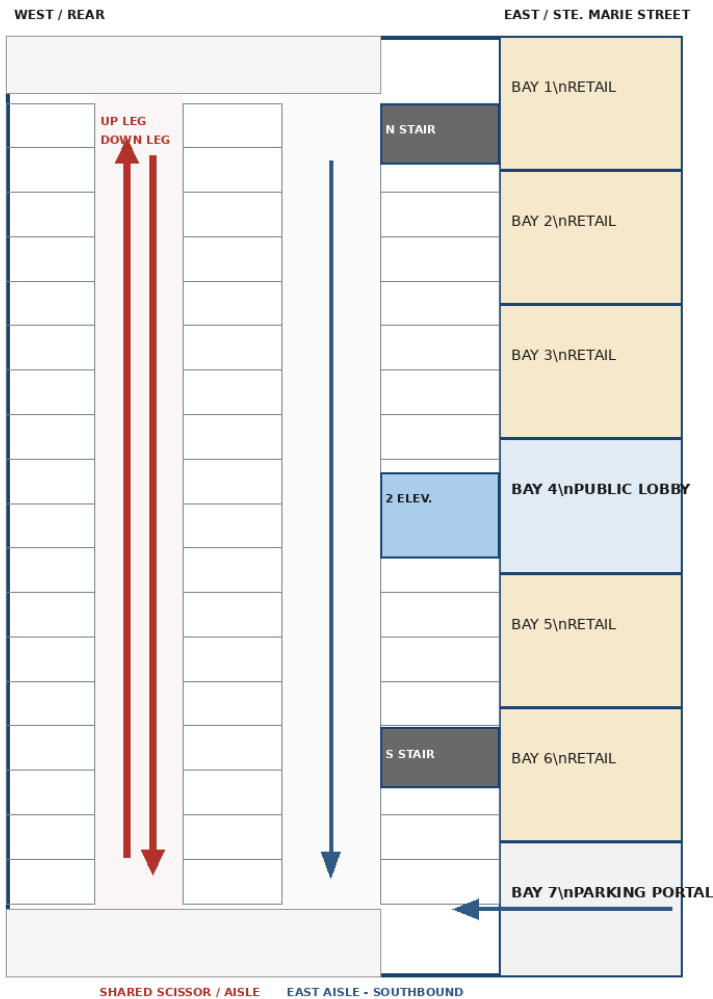
DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD:
A CATALYST FOR PARKING, HOUSING AND PROSPERITY

FIGURE C10.0

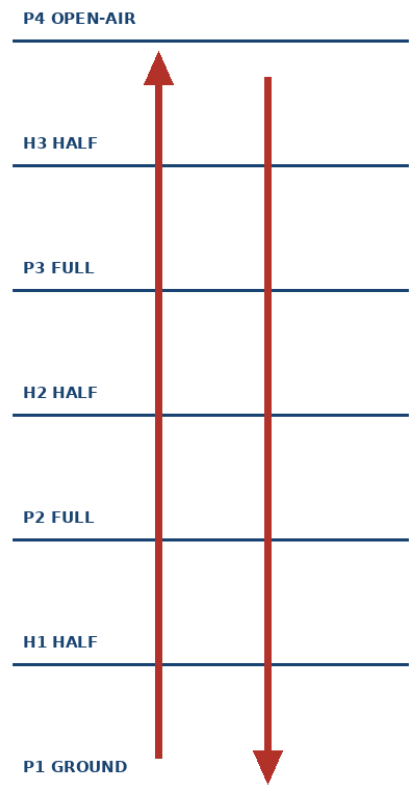
PARKING STRATEGY



A. P1 GROUND DATUM



B. SEVEN-DATUM ORGANIZATION



Two separate directional ramp legs
connect the alternating parking datums.

CIRCULATION

- West aisle / ramp band: northbound
- North crossover: west-to-east
- East aisle: southbound
- Bay 7 Parking Portal: two-way

Structured parking provides several operational advantages over the existing surface lot:

- Greater parking capacity on the same municipal footprint;
- Improved protection from weather;
- Enhanced lighting and security;
- Improved accessibility;
- More efficient traffic circulation;
- Improved pedestrian safety through defined pathways; and
- Flexibility for future technology upgrades, including electric vehicle charging infrastructure and parking guidance systems.

These improvements enhance both the user experience and the long-term value of the municipal parking asset.

4.8 Integration with the Development

A defining feature of the proposal is the integration of parking with residential and commercial uses.

The parking structure is not an isolated facility. It supports:

- approximately 7,300 square feet of street-oriented commercial space;
- 30 purpose-built rental apartments;
- active pedestrian frontages along Ste. Marie Street; and
- a strengthened downtown streetscape.

By combining these uses within a single development, the Town can achieve multiple strategic objectives through one coordinated investment.

4.9 Chapter Summary

The existing 87-space surface parking lot provides an essential public service but represents a relatively low-intensity use of valuable municipally owned land.

The proposed structured parking solution preserves and significantly expands the public parking function while enabling new workforce housing, market rental housing, commercial activity and long-term municipal assessment growth.

Through careful design development, the parking structure has been integrated with the architectural program to create a project that is operationally efficient, financially viable and compatible with the surrounding Downtown Heritage Conservation District.

Chapter 4 – Key Takeaways

- Existing public parking supply: 87 spaces.
- Verified proposed parking: 196 total spaces, including 181 public spaces and 15 residential-dedicated spaces; net increase in public parking: 94 spaces.
- Dedicated residential parking: 15 spaces.
- Public parking remains the primary municipal function of the site.
- Structured parking significantly increases capacity without acquiring additional downtown land.

- The parking structure enables workforce housing, commercial development and long-term municipal assessment growth.
- Parking should be viewed as essential municipal infrastructure supporting economic development, tourism, housing and downtown vitality.

Chapter 5

Residential Development

5.1 Introduction

Housing availability has emerged as one of the defining challenges facing many Ontario communities. In Collingwood, sustained population growth, economic expansion and increasing housing costs have contributed to a shortage of rental accommodation for residents employed within the local economy.

The residential component of the proposed development has therefore been designed to address a specific community need while remaining compatible with the scale and character of the downtown.

Rather than maximizing residential density, the proposal seeks an appropriate balance between municipal parking, commercial activity and long-term residential use.

5.2 Housing Need

Like many communities across Ontario, Collingwood has experienced increasing demand for rental housing across a broad range of income levels.

Local employers, service providers, healthcare institutions, hospitality businesses and retailers all depend upon a stable workforce that can reasonably live within or near the community.

Providing additional rental housing within walking distance of employment, services and public amenities contributes to a more resilient local economy while reducing transportation demand and supporting year-round downtown activity.

This project has been developed with that objective in mind.

5.3 Residential Program

The proposed development includes 30 purpose-built rental apartments distributed over three residential floors above the commercial podium.

Planning unit sizes are approximately 500 sq. ft. for bachelor units, 600 sq. ft. for one-bedroom units and 700 sq. ft. for two-bedroom units. Levels 2 and 3 each contain 11 workforce rental units and 2 market corner units; Level 4 contains 4 market-rental penthouses.

The residential program has been intentionally sized to complement the municipal parking function while maintaining compatibility with the surrounding downtown environment.

Table 5-1 – Residential Program

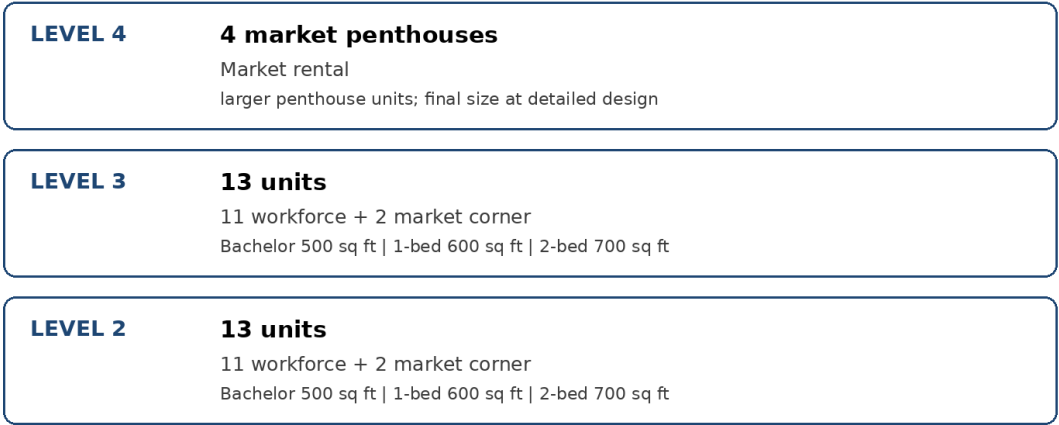
Unit Type	Number
Workforce Rental Units	22
Market Rental Units	8
Total Residential Units	30

The residential mix has been selected to provide a range of housing choices while supporting a financially sustainable rental project.

Figure 5-1

Figure 5-1 - Residential Unit Distribution

30 rental homes: 22 workforce rental + 8 market rental



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FIGURE C11.0

HOUSING STRATEGY

Residential program unchanged; parking relationship updated only to locked M0.7

30 TOTAL HOMES	22 WORKFORCE	8 MARKET	15 RESIDENTIAL PARKING
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A. RESIDENTIAL PROGRAM — FROZEN

LEVEL 4	4 MARKET PENTHOUSES 10 ft east setback	BAY 4 2 ELEV. SECURE ACCESS	M0.7 SPLIT-LEVEL STRUCTURED PARKING BEHIND FRONTAGE
LEVEL 3	13 UNITS 11 workforce + 2 market corner	BAY 4 2 ELEV. SECURE ACCESS	M0.7 SPLIT-LEVEL STRUCTURED PARKING BEHIND FRONTAGE
LEVEL 2	13 UNITS 11 workforce + 2 market corner	BAY 4 2 ELEV. SECURE ACCESS	M0.7 SPLIT-LEVEL STRUCTURED PARKING BEHIND FRONTAGE

UNIT MIX / ROLE

22 WORKFORCE RENTAL HOMES	8 MARKET HOMES
---------------------------	----------------

B. PARKING RELATIONSHIP — M0.7 COORDINATION

Residential allocation	15 dedicated spaces retained.
Parking system	Compact split-level / scissor-ramp structure behind the residential frontage.
Resident access	Through Bay 4 double through-car elevators to the secure residential hallway.
Housing geometry	No change to unit count, unit mix, residential floor depth or Level 4 setback.
Parking detail	Detailed seven-datum parking geometry is intentionally not repeated on C11.0; see C9.0 / C10.0.

C. FROZEN HOUSING CONTROLS

- Levels 2 and 3: 13 units each; 11 workforce + 2 market corner units.
- Level 4: 4 market penthouses; east frontage recessed 10 ft.
- Total: 30 homes = 22 workforce rental + 8 market.

CONTROL / STATUS

Housing content follows the locked 30-home program. Parking relationship updated to M0.7 Rev. M only.
No staged-ramp / conventional four-level parking geometry is shown. Planning concept only; not for construction.

Residential Unit Distribution

5.4 Workforce Housing

The majority of the proposed apartments are intended to serve Collingwood's workforce.

For the purposes of this report, workforce housing refers to market-based rental accommodation designed for individuals and families employed within the local economy. These households include workers in healthcare, education, hospitality, retail, municipal services, skilled trades, manufacturing, tourism and other essential sectors.

The units are not proposed as subsidized housing. Rather, they are intended to increase the supply of professionally managed rental accommodation within the community.

By increasing overall rental supply, the project contributes to improved housing choice while supporting local employers who rely on a stable workforce.

Author's Observation

Workforce housing is frequently discussed in terms of social policy. Equally important is its role as economic infrastructure. Employers can only expand and retain staff when suitable housing is available within a reasonable commuting distance. Investment in workforce housing therefore supports not only residents but also local businesses, municipal services and the long-term economic vitality of the community.

5.5 Market Rental Housing

The proposed development also includes eight market rental apartments.

These larger units are intended to diversify the residential mix and strengthen the financial viability of the overall project.

A mixed rental program encourages a broader range of residents to live downtown while supporting a balanced and inclusive residential community.

The combination of workforce and market rental units also reduces reliance on any single market segment and contributes to long-term operational stability.

5.6 Residential Design

Residential floors have been organized around a centrally located corridor served by elevators and enclosed exit stairs.

The layout emphasizes:

- efficient circulation;
- natural daylight at unit exteriors;
- barrier-free access;
- clear separation between residential and parking areas;

- secure resident access;
- convenient access to parking and commercial services.

The recessed fourth floor reduces the perceived scale of the building from the street while providing larger market rental apartments with enhanced views and outdoor amenity opportunities.

5.7 Residential Parking

The proposed residential component has been allocated 15 dedicated parking spaces in accordance with the minimum residential parking requirement of the Town of Collingwood Zoning By-law, based on a ratio of 0.5 parking spaces per dwelling unit for new residential uses within the Downtown Core Commercial (C1) Zone. This results in a requirement of 15 residential parking spaces for the proposed 30-unit development.

The parking ratio reflects a downtown mixed-use environment where residents are within walking distance of employment, shopping, restaurants, parks, community facilities and transit services. It also recognizes that purpose-built rental developments in central urban locations typically require lower parking ratios than suburban developments because of reduced automobile dependence and shared access to community amenities.

The fifteen residential parking spaces are incorporated within the structured parking facility and are intended to be assigned to residential tenants. Although reserved for tenant use, these spaces remain revenue-generating assets and have been recognized as such in the financial analysis.

By integrating residential parking within the municipal parking structure, the project avoids the need for a separate residential parking facility, improving land-use efficiency and reducing overall project costs while preserving a substantial increase in public parking capacity.

The parking assumptions used for the residential component are reflected in the financial analysis presented in Chapter 7 and form part of the overall development feasibility assessment.

5.8 Living Downtown

One of the principal benefits of the proposal is the introduction of a permanent residential population into an area that is currently occupied almost exclusively by surface parking.

Residents living within walking distance of shops, restaurants, parks, community facilities and employment opportunities contribute to a more active downtown throughout the year.

This increased residential presence supports local businesses beyond the peak tourism season and contributes to a safer, more vibrant public realm through regular day-to-day activity.

The project therefore strengthens both the economic and social sustainability of downtown Collingwood.

5.9 Chapter Summary

The proposed residential component has been carefully integrated with the municipal parking and commercial functions of the development.

The program of 30 purpose-built rental apartments, including 22 workforce rental units and 8 market rental units, addresses a demonstrated need for additional rental housing while remaining compatible with the scale of the downtown.

By introducing a permanent residential population into the heart of the community, the project supports local employers, strengthens downtown businesses and contributes to a more complete and resilient urban environment.

Chapter 5 – Key Takeaways

- 30 purpose-built rental apartments.
 - 22 workforce rental units.
 - 8 market rental units.
 - Rental housing integrated above municipal parking.
 - Walking distance to employment, shopping, parks and community services.
 - Mixed-income rental program supports both housing choice and economic development.
 - Purpose-built rental housing strengthens the vitality of Downtown Collingwood throughout the year.
-

Author's Observation

The residential parking allocation should not be viewed as a reduction in public parking. Rather, it is a planning requirement necessary to support the residential component of the development. The proposed structured parking facility accommodates both the required residential parking and a significant net increase in public parking on the same municipal property.

Chapter 6

Commercial Development

6.1 Introduction

The commercial component of the proposed development plays a critical role in achieving the overall objectives of the project. While municipal parking provides the foundation and the residential component introduces a permanent downtown population, the ground-floor commercial space activates the streetscape, strengthens the local economy and contributes to the financial viability of the development.

The proposed commercial space has therefore been planned as an integral component of the project rather than as an afterthought.

6.2 Why This Site?

The property at 140 Ste. Marie Street possesses several characteristics that make it uniquely suited for mixed-use redevelopment.

First, the property is already in municipal ownership, eliminating one of the principal barriers to downtown redevelopment.

Second, the site is located within the Downtown Core, within a short walking distance of Hurontario Street, civic facilities, restaurants, retail businesses, public parking and community amenities.

Third, the existing municipal parking function can be retained and expanded through structured parking, allowing additional land uses to be introduced without sacrificing the public purpose of the site.

Finally, the site's size permits a comprehensive redevelopment that would be difficult to achieve on many smaller downtown properties.

Taken together, these characteristics provide an opportunity to demonstrate how municipal land can be used more efficiently while continuing to serve the public interest.

6.3 Commercial Program

The proposed development includes approximately 7,300 square feet of ground-floor commercial space fronting onto Ste. Marie Street.

The commercial frontage is divided into five individual retail units, allowing a variety of businesses to occupy the building while maintaining the traditional rhythm of downtown storefronts.

The retail units are intended to accommodate a broad range of commercial uses, including professional services, specialty retail, personal services, food-related businesses and other downtown-compatible enterprises.

The flexible configuration also allows adjacent units to be combined should larger commercial tenants be identified in the future.

Table 6-1 – Commercial Program

Description	Value
Commercial Floor Area	~7,300 sq. ft.
Retail Bays	5
Building Frontage	Ste. Marie Street
Access	Individual street entrances and parking-side rear doors

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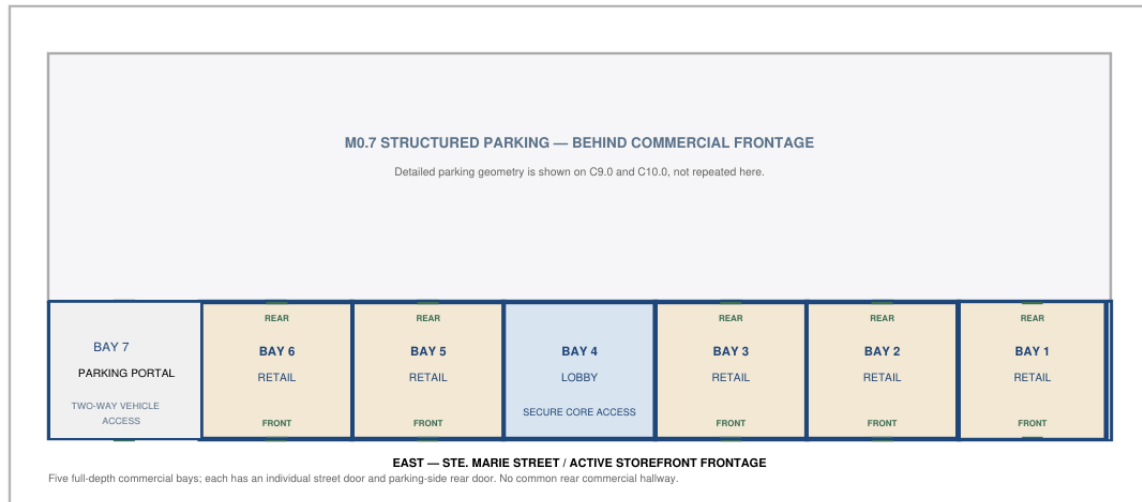
FIGURE C12.0

COMMERCIAL ACTIVATION

Frozen commercial program | M0.7 parking-side coordination | integration review

~7,300 SQ. FT. COMMERCIAL	5 ACTIVE STOREFRONTS	2 DOORS / RETAIL BAY	1 BAY 7 PORTAL
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A. GROUND-FLOOR COMMERCIAL ORGANIZATION — FROZEN



B. M0.7 PARKING-SIDE INTERFACE

Rear commercial access	Rear doors retained for Bays 1, 2, 3, 5 and 6.
Protected access zones	Rear doors remain clear of cores and protected landing/access zones.
Bay 4	Lobby and double through-car elevator/core relationship remains unchanged.
Bay 7	Parking Portal provides two-way public vehicle access from Ste. Marie Street.
Parking depiction	No obsolete staged-ramp or conventional four-level geometry is carried forward.

C. COMMERCIAL ACTIVATION PRINCIPLES

- ~7,300 sq. ft. of street-oriented commercial space remains unchanged.
- Five active storefronts occupy Bays 1, 2, 3, 5 and 6.
- Each commercial bay is full-depth with its own front and rear door.
- Bay 4 remains the public/residential lobby and secure vertical-access core.
- Parking remains behind the active Ste. Marie Street frontage.

140 STE. MARIE STREET
DOWNTOWN COLLINGWOOD MIXED-USE DEVELOPMENT
PLANNING CONCEPT — NOT FOR CONSTRUCTION

FIGURE
C12.0
COMMERCIAL ACTIVATION

EDITION
1.4
M0.7 INTEGRATION
REVIEW

6.4 Streetscape

Successful downtowns are defined by active streets rather than parking lots.

Accordingly, the building has been designed so that commercial storefronts, rather than the parking structure, define the public face of the development.

Large storefront windows, recessed entrances, generous glazing and a consistent architectural rhythm create an inviting pedestrian environment while reinforcing the traditional character of downtown Collingwood.

The structured parking facility is located behind the commercial frontage and is largely concealed from public view.

6.5 Supporting Downtown Businesses

The proposed commercial space should be viewed as complementary to, rather than competitive with, existing downtown businesses.

The additional residential population generated by the project will increase year-round demand for goods and services within walking distance of the site.

Similarly, the expansion of public parking capacity improves customer access to existing businesses throughout the downtown, particularly during peak tourism periods and community events.

The combined effect is expected to strengthen the economic vitality of the downtown rather than redistribute existing activity.

Author's Observation

Public parking and downtown commerce are mutually dependent. Businesses rely upon convenient customer access, while parking facilities derive their value from the activity they support. Evaluating either component in isolation understates the broader economic relationship between municipal infrastructure and private investment.

6.6 Economic Benefits

The commercial component contributes to the project in several ways:

- additional commercial assessment;
- employment during construction;
- permanent employment opportunities following occupancy;
- increased downtown business activity;
- enhanced property values;
- increased municipal tax revenues;
- improved utilization of municipal infrastructure.

The project also creates opportunities for new businesses to establish themselves within the downtown while providing existing businesses with a larger year-round customer base.

6.7 Municipal Assessment

Redevelopment of the existing surface parking lot will significantly increase the assessed value of the property.

While the municipal parking component remains publicly owned, the residential and commercial components introduce new assessment that contributes to the long-term financial sustainability of municipal services.

The resulting increase in assessment represents an important secondary benefit of the project that extends well beyond parking revenues alone.

6.8 Integration with the Downtown

The proposal has been designed to reinforce the established urban form of Downtown Collingwood.

Key design features include:

- active commercial frontage;
- frequent pedestrian entrances;
- transparent storefront glazing;
- heritage-compatible architectural proportions;
- continuous street wall;
- recessed upper storey;
- enhanced pedestrian environment.

Together, these features ensure that the project contributes positively to the evolving character of the downtown while respecting its historic context.

6.9 Chapter Summary

The proposed commercial component transforms the public face of the development from a surface parking lot into an active streetscape that supports downtown businesses, creates employment opportunities and strengthens the municipal assessment base.

By integrating approximately 7,300 square feet of commercial space with structured parking and residential development, the project delivers multiple economic and community benefits while preserving the public parking function that remains essential to the success of Downtown Collingwood.

Chapter 6 – Key Takeaways

- Approximately 7,300 sq. ft. of new commercial space.
- Five flexible street-oriented retail units.
- Active frontage along Ste. Marie Street.
- Commercial uses complement existing downtown businesses.
- Increased municipal assessment and long-term tax revenue.
- Additional residential population supports year-round economic activity.
- Parking, housing and commercial development function as a single, integrated downtown revitalization strategy.

Chapter 7

Financial Analysis and Business Case

7.1 Introduction

The proposed redevelopment of 140 Ste. Marie Street represents a significant investment in municipal infrastructure, housing and downtown revitalization. The financial analysis presented in this chapter has been prepared at a planning level to evaluate the overall feasibility of the project and to demonstrate how public and private investment can be combined to achieve multiple community objectives.

The analysis recognizes that the project consists of three distinct but interrelated components:

- a municipally owned structured public parking facility;
- privately developed and operated residential rental housing; and
- privately developed and operated ground-floor commercial space.

Rather than evaluating these components independently, the analysis considers their collective contribution to the long-term economic, social and financial sustainability of Downtown Collingwood.

7.2 Financial Dashboard

The following dashboard summarizes the coordinated planning-level assumptions and financial outcomes used for final publication, including the verified scissor-ramp parking concept.

Table 7-1 – Project Dashboard

Category	Value
Existing Public Parking	87 spaces
Estimated Net Increase in Public Parking	94 spaces
Dedicated Residential Parking	15 spaces
Residential Units	30
Workforce Rental Units	22
Market Rental Units	8
Commercial Floor Area	7,300 sq. ft.
Municipal Construction Investment	~\$18.106 million
Private Construction Investment	~\$14.8 million
Total Project Investment	~\$32.906 million
Delivery Model	Public–Private Partnership

*Planning-level Class D basis. Verified parking program: 196 total spaces, including 181 public and 15 residential-dedicated spaces. Final geometry and costs remain subject to detailed design and Class C estimating.

Author's Observation

The financial success of this project should be measured by more than construction cost or parking revenue. The redevelopment creates a permanent municipal asset, expands public parking, increases the municipal assessment base, supports downtown businesses, introduces new housing and makes more efficient use of municipally owned land. These outcomes collectively define the project's long-term value.

7.3 Basis of Estimate

The financial estimates presented in this report have been prepared for planning and decision-making purposes. They are intended to establish the order of magnitude of the investment required and to evaluate the overall feasibility of the proposed development.

The estimates are based on:

- the conceptual site and building design presented in this report;
- current construction cost information;
- comparable structured parking and mixed-use developments;
- typical professional service allowances;
- financing and contingency allowances appropriate for a planning-level estimate.

Accordingly, these estimates should be regarded as a Class D planning estimate and will require refinement through detailed design, geotechnical investigation, structural engineering, architectural design, market testing and competitive procurement.

7.4 Construction Cost Summary

The estimated construction cost has been divided into its principal components.

Table 7-2 – Planning-Level Construction Cost

Component	Estimated Cost
Municipal Parking Structure	\$12.285 million
Shared Vertical Circulation	\$1.421 million
Residential Building	\$9.5 million
Commercial Shell	\$1.7 million
Site Development	\$1.3 million
Construction Total	\$26.206 million

The parking structure remains the largest single municipal investment. The coordinated Class D scissor-ramp comparison establishes a \$12.285 million parking-structure control and a \$1.421 million shared-circulation allowance, producing a \$1.206 million premium relative to the earlier staged-ramp comparison.

7.5 Total Project Investment

Beyond construction costs, the project includes professional services, financing, contingencies and other project-related expenditures necessary to complete the development.

Table 7-3 – Total Project Investment

Component	Estimated Cost
Construction	\$26.206 million
Professional Services	\$2.8 million
Contingency	\$2.7 million
Financing and Carrying Costs	\$1.2 million
Total Project Investment	\$32.906 million

The estimates include appropriate allowances for architectural and engineering design, approvals, legal services, project management, financing and construction contingencies consistent with a planning-level analysis.

7.6 Public–Private Partnership

The proposed delivery model contemplates a partnership between the Town and a private-sector development partner.

Under this approach:

Town of Collingwood

- retains ownership of the land;
- funds and owns the municipal parking structure;
- retains ownership and operation of the public parking system;
- participates in the delivery of shared building infrastructure.

Private Development Partner

- finances the residential and commercial components;
- constructs the mixed-use building;
- owns and operates the residential rental apartments;
- owns and manages the commercial premises.

This allocation of responsibilities allows each party to invest in the components most closely aligned with their long-term objectives while sharing common infrastructure where appropriate.

7.7 Potential Funding Strategy

The financial analysis demonstrates that the project is feasible based on the planning-level assumptions presented in this report.

While the project does not depend upon senior government assistance to establish its feasibility, Provincial and Federal funding programs could substantially reduce the Town's capital investment and improve the overall financial performance of the development.

Potential sources of funding may include:

- Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation (CMHC) housing programs;
- Federation of Canadian Municipalities (FCM) initiatives;
- Infrastructure Ontario financing programs;
- Provincial housing and infrastructure funding opportunities;
- municipal land contribution or long-term ground lease arrangements;
- conventional private financing and equity investment.

The availability and eligibility of these programs will depend upon the funding criteria in place at the time of implementation.

7.8 Sensitivity Analysis

As with any major capital project, future construction costs, financing conditions and market factors may vary from the assumptions used in this report.

The reconciled 25-year municipal discounted cash flow (DCF) uses a 4.0% discount rate and 2.0% annual escalation. The working base-case Catalyst net present value (NPV) is approximately (\$9.11 million), with a planning sensitivity range of approximately (\$11.03 million) conservative to (\$7.18 million) optimistic. These values are planning-level delta-reconciled results, not a developer pro forma or financing commitment.

The available financial control specifies 2.0% annual operating-cost growth but does not establish a supported Year-1 operating-cost amount. The prior operating-cost stream is therefore held unchanged in this reconciliation. Detailed financial modelling should be updated during subsequent phases as quantified operating budgets, market conditions and procurement outcomes become available.

7.9 Financial Conclusions

The financial analysis supports the conclusion that the proposed redevelopment of 140 Ste. Marie Street is financially achievable through a collaborative public–private partnership.

The investment delivers multiple long-term municipal benefits, including:

- a substantial increase in public parking capacity;
- new purpose-built rental housing;
- additional commercial space;
- increased municipal assessment;
- improved downtown economic activity;
- more efficient use of municipal land;

- a catalyst for future downtown revitalization.

From a planning perspective, the project represents an opportunity to address several community priorities through a single coordinated investment rather than through separate, stand-alone initiatives.

Chapter 7 – Key Takeaways

- Total Project Investment: approximately \$31.7 million.
- Municipal Investment: approximately \$16.9 million.
- Private Investment: approximately \$14.8 million.
- The project is structured as a Public–Private Partnership.
- The reconciled base-case 25-year municipal NPV is approximately (\$9.11 million), subject to the stated operating-cost limitation and future Class C refinement.
- Senior government funding could improve, but is not essential to, the project's viability.
- The project delivers lasting municipal assets while supporting housing, economic development and downtown revitalization.

Chapter 8

Implementation Strategy and Next Steps

8.1 Introduction

The proposed redevelopment of 140 Ste. Marie Street represents a long-term investment in municipal infrastructure and downtown revitalization. While the project is ambitious in scope, it can be implemented through a logical sequence of planning, design, procurement and construction activities.

This chapter outlines a practical implementation strategy intended to reduce project risk, maintain flexibility and provide Council with appropriate decision points throughout the development process.

The implementation strategy recognizes that this report represents a planning-level feasibility study. Additional technical work, public consultation and detailed financial analysis will be required before construction proceeds.

8.2 Guiding Principles

Implementation of the project should be guided by the following principles:

- maintain municipal ownership of the public parking asset;
- ensure compatibility with the Downtown Heritage Conservation District;
- encourage private-sector investment;
- protect municipal financial interests;
- maintain transparency throughout the approval process;
- maximize opportunities for Provincial and Federal funding;
- deliver measurable community benefits.

These principles should guide all subsequent decisions as the project advances.

8.3 Recommended Implementation Process

A phased implementation process is recommended to allow key decisions to be made at appropriate milestones while minimizing unnecessary expenditures.

Phase 1 – Council Direction

- Receive the Planning-Level Project Development Report.
- Confirm the project as a strategic municipal priority.
- Authorize further investigation and stakeholder consultation.

Phase 2 – Project Validation

- Confirm parking demand and operational requirements.
- Complete updated market analysis for residential and commercial uses.
- Review planning and regulatory requirements.
- Refine the financial model.

Phase 3 – Partnership Development

- Prepare a Request for Expressions of Interest (RFEI).
- Engage the development community.
- Evaluate potential public-private partnership models.
- Select a preferred implementation approach.

Phase 4 – Detailed Design

- Architectural design.
- Structural and civil engineering.
- Transportation and parking analysis.
- Heritage Conservation District review.
- Cost estimate refinement.
- Development approvals.

Phase 5 – Procurement and Construction

- Tender municipal infrastructure.
- Finalize development agreements.
- Secure financing.
- Commence construction.
- Complete commissioning and occupancy.

Figure 8-1 - Project Delivery Roadmap

Illustrative implementation sequence; timing to be confirmed through Council direction and procurement



8.4 Public Consultation

Meaningful public engagement should occur throughout project development.

Consultation should include:

- neighbouring property owners;
- downtown businesses;
- the Downtown BIA;
- residents;
- accessibility representatives;
- heritage stakeholders;
- potential development partners.

Public consultation should focus not only on the design of the building but also on the broader community benefits associated with expanded public parking, additional housing and downtown revitalization.

8.5 Heritage Review

As the property is located within the Downtown Heritage Conservation District, detailed design should be undertaken in consultation with municipal heritage staff and the Heritage Advisory Committee.

The architectural principles illustrated in this report demonstrate that a contemporary mixed-use development can respect the established character of Downtown Collingwood while introducing new investment and activity.

Detailed design will provide opportunities to refine architectural materials, storefront design, lighting, signage and landscape treatments in accordance with the Heritage Conservation District Plan.

8.6 Development Partnership

The Town should consider engaging the private development community through a transparent and competitive process.

Potential partnership models may include:

- long-term ground lease;
- joint development agreement;
- design-build-finance arrangement;
- phased development agreement.

The preferred model should be selected based on market interest, financial performance, risk allocation and the Town's long-term strategic objectives.

Author's Observation

The success of this project will depend as much on selecting the right development partner as on the quality of the design itself. A transparent procurement process that clearly defines municipal objectives and allocates responsibilities appropriately will improve project outcomes, reduce risk and encourage strong private-sector participation.

8.7 Project Schedule

A realistic implementation schedule will depend upon Council direction, market conditions and funding opportunities.

Based on typical municipal project delivery timelines, the following sequence is considered achievable.

Table 8-1 – Illustrative Project Schedule

Milestone	Target
Council Consideration	2026
Project Validation and Consultation	2026-2027
Partnership Procurement	2027
Detailed Design and Approvals	2027-2028
Construction Commencement	2028
Project Completion	2030

These dates are illustrative and should be refined as the project advances.

8.8 Risks and Mitigation

Major capital projects inevitably involve uncertainty. The principal project risks include:

- construction cost escalation;
- interest rate fluctuations;
- changes in funding programs;
- market demand;
- procurement outcomes;
- regulatory approvals.

These risks can be managed through staged decision-making, competitive procurement, detailed design, independent cost estimating and ongoing financial review.

The phased implementation strategy recommended in this report provides multiple opportunities to reassess the project before significant capital commitments are made.

8.9 Conclusions

The proposed redevelopment of 140 Ste. Marie Street is capable of being delivered through a structured and transparent implementation process that combines municipal leadership with private-sector expertise.

By proceeding in clearly defined stages, the Town can continue to refine the project while maintaining flexibility, managing financial risk and ensuring that the final development achieves the objectives established by Council.

Chapter 8 – Key Takeaways

- Phased implementation reduces project risk.
- Municipal ownership of the public parking asset is maintained.
- Public-private partnership provides an effective delivery model.
- Public consultation and heritage review remain integral to the process.
- Multiple decision points allow Council to confirm direction before advancing to the next phase.
- A transparent procurement process will encourage strong market participation.
- The project can be delivered using established municipal planning and procurement practices.

Chapter 9

Conclusions and Recommendations

9.1 Introduction

This Planning-Level Project Development Report has examined the feasibility of redeveloping the municipally owned property at 140 Ste. Marie Street as a mixed-use development incorporating structured public parking, purpose-built rental housing and ground-floor commercial space.

The analysis demonstrates that these three objectives are not mutually exclusive. Rather, when carefully integrated, they reinforce one another to create a project capable of delivering lasting economic, social and municipal benefits.

The proposed redevelopment represents an opportunity to transform an underutilized municipal asset into a catalyst for downtown revitalization while maintaining and significantly expanding the site's public parking function.

9.2 Principal Findings

Based on the planning, technical and financial analyses presented in this report, the following principal findings are reached.

Municipal Parking

The proposed structured parking facility can substantially increase the supply of public parking while replacing the existing surface parking lot with a more efficient use of municipally owned land.

The planning-level design demonstrates that approximately 200 additional public parking spaces can be accommodated while providing the residential parking required by the Town's Zoning By-law.

Housing

The project provides 30 purpose-built rental apartments, including 22 workforce rental units and 8 market rental units, helping address the growing demand for rental accommodation in Downtown Collingwood.

The residential component is appropriately scaled for the site and complements the municipal parking function without compromising the heritage character of the downtown.

Commercial Development

Approximately 7,300 square feet of new commercial space strengthens the economic vitality of the downtown by introducing additional storefronts, increasing employment opportunities and supporting existing businesses through increased pedestrian activity.

Financial Feasibility

The planning-level financial analysis indicates that the project is capable of being delivered through a partnership between the Town and a private-sector development partner.

The recommended delivery model allocates responsibilities in a manner consistent with the long-term interests of both parties while reducing municipal financial exposure.

Municipal Leadership

The project demonstrates how municipally owned land can be used to achieve multiple public policy objectives through a single coordinated investment.

Rather than addressing parking, housing and economic development independently, the proposal integrates these priorities into one comprehensive redevelopment initiative.

9.3 Recommendations

Based upon the findings of this report, the following actions are recommended for Council's consideration.

Recommendation 1

Receive this Planning-Level Project Development Report as a strategic evaluation of redevelopment opportunities for the municipal parking lot at 140 Ste. Marie Street.

Recommendation 2

Recognize the property as a potential catalyst site capable of supporting structured public parking, purpose-built rental housing and street-oriented commercial development.

Recommendation 3

Authorize additional technical investigations, market analysis and financial refinement to confirm the planning assumptions presented in this report.

Recommendation 4

Undertake a comprehensive public consultation and stakeholder engagement program to further refine the proposed concept and inform future Council decision-making.

Recommendation 5

Explore partnership opportunities with the private development community through a transparent and competitive procurement process.

Recommendation 6

Investigate Provincial and Federal funding opportunities that may assist in reducing municipal capital costs while supporting housing and downtown revitalization objectives.

Recommendation 7

Subject to the outcomes of subsequent investigations and Council direction, proceed with detailed design and implementation planning.

9.4 Closing Statement

Downtown Collingwood has evolved over more than a century through a series of thoughtful public and private investments. Each generation has contributed to the community's character by responding to the needs of its time while respecting the foundations established by those who came before.

Today, Collingwood faces a new set of challenges. Demand for public parking continues to grow. Housing affordability and workforce accommodation have become pressing concerns. Businesses require a vibrant and accessible downtown to remain competitive. Municipal resources must be invested wisely to achieve the greatest possible public benefit.

The redevelopment of 140 Ste. Marie Street presents an opportunity to address these challenges through a single integrated project.

By combining structured public parking, purpose-built rental housing and active commercial uses on municipally owned land, the proposal demonstrates how one strategic investment can produce lasting benefits for residents, businesses and visitors alike.

This report does not represent the final design for the site. Rather, it establishes a practical and financially achievable framework upon which future work can be built.

If ultimately pursued, the project has the potential to become a model for downtown intensification, municipal innovation and responsible stewardship of public assets.

Author's Observation

Communities are often defined not by the challenges they face, but by the opportunities they choose to pursue. The redevelopment of 140 Ste. Marie Street offers an opportunity to address several longstanding community priorities through one coordinated initiative. Whether this specific proposal proceeds or evolves into another form, the underlying principle remains the same: municipally owned land should be used thoughtfully to create lasting public value for current and future generations.

PROJECT AT A GLANCE

Downtown Collingwood: A Catalyst for Parking, Housing and Prosperity

Planning-Level Project Development Report

140 Ste. Marie Street, Collingwood, Ontario

Project Vision

Transform an underutilized municipal surface parking lot into a vibrant mixed-use development that expands public parking, provides purpose-built rental housing, strengthens the downtown economy and respects the character of the Downtown Heritage Conservation District.

Project Highlights

Municipal Parking

- Existing Public Parking: 87 spaces
- Net Increase in Public Parking: 94 spaces
- Dedicated Residential Parking: 15 spaces
- Split-level structured parking using seven alternating parking datums
- EV-ready and bicycle parking incorporated
- Municipal ownership and operation retained

Residential Development

- 30 purpose-built rental apartments
 - o 22 Workforce Rental Units
 - o 8 Market Rental Units
- Four-storey building with recessed fourth floor
- Barrier-free design
- Secure residential access

Commercial Development

- Approximately 7,300 sq. ft.
- Five street-oriented commercial units
- Active frontage along Ste. Marie Street
- Flexible retail and service opportunities
- Supports year-round downtown activity

Financial Summary

Item Value

Municipal Investment ~\$18.106 million

Private Investment ~\$14.8 million

Total Project Investment ~\$32.906 million

Delivery Model Public–Private Partnership

Planning-level (Class D) estimate.

Community Benefits

- ✓ Significant increase in public parking
- ✓ Purpose-built workforce rental housing
- ✓ Additional market rental housing
- ✓ New commercial assessment
- ✓ Expanded municipal assessment base
- ✓ Increased downtown economic activity
- ✓ Improved utilization of municipally owned land
- ✓ Heritage-compatible urban design
- ✓ Catalyst for future downtown revitalization

Recommended Next Steps

1. Receive the Planning-Level Project Development Report.
2. Confirm the site as a strategic municipal redevelopment opportunity.
3. Complete detailed technical and financial investigations.
4. Undertake comprehensive public consultation.
5. Engage the private development community through a transparent procurement process.
6. Pursue Provincial and Federal funding opportunities.
7. Proceed to detailed design, subject to future Council direction.

Closing Statement

The proposed redevelopment of 140 Ste. Marie Street demonstrates how a single municipal property can address multiple community priorities through one coordinated investment. By integrating structured public parking, purpose-built rental housing and active commercial space, the project creates lasting public value while strengthening the long-term vitality of Downtown Collingwood